18.10 Opioid and Drug Withdrawal

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My whole body aches and I cannot stop yawning." **Objective** • Sweating, pupils dilated, goosebumps • Vomiting, diarrhea • Last used 18 hours ago	**ACTUAL** **Acute substance withdrawal syndrome** related to abrupt cessation of opioids as evidenced by sweating, dilated pupils, vomiting and aches.	Gets through withdrawal safely, with symptoms he can tolerate.	• Score the withdrawal with a validated scale. • Give substitution or symptom-relief medication as prescribed. • Keep him hydrated. • Keep his surroundings calm.	Withdrawal safe: **goal met**.
Subjective • "I want to stop but I am afraid I will use again." **Objective** • Has relapsed before • Unsure about treatment	**ACTUAL** **Ineffective coping** related to substance dependence as evidenced by repeated relapse.	Can name what triggers a relapse and who will support him.	• Use motivational interviewing. • Refer to addiction services. • Warn him that the risk of overdose is higher after a period without using.	Describes his plan: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Vomiting and diarrhea	**RISK** **Risk for deficient fluid volume** as evidenced by risk factors: vomiting and diarrhea during withdrawal.	Stays well hydrated.	• Keep an I&O chart. • Encourage drinking; give IV fluids if ordered. • Give the antiemetic and antidiarrheal as prescribed.	Hydrated: **goal met**.